

No Longer Geeky, WEARABLES Are STYLE STATEMENTS



Janani Gopalakrishnan Vikram is a technically-qualified freelance writer, editor and hands-on mom based in Chennai



Players benefit from technology embedded in clothes, which collect data to help them analyse and improve their game (Source: Playertek)

During training, most professional football players wear a small tracker under their shirt. The tracker is embedded with a range of sensors like accelerometers, gyroscopes and compasses, as well as a GPS chip and other bits of technology. With this, it becomes possible to track players' position, direction, speed of moving across the field, acceleration or deceleration, and more. By combining data gathered by the trackers worn by multiple players, it becomes possible to study their relative positions and the impact of each jump and tackle. This helps to determine why a game turned out to be the way it did, and learn lessons for future games.

Such training aids are helpful for amateurs too. For instance, Catapult's Playertek smart vest can not only improve your game but also compare you with top premier league players!

Indeed, wearable technology has matured beyond our imagination. Although smartwatches, fitness bands and virtual reality headsets continue to top this space, there is a lot more technology to wear today. You can wear technology devices as a watch or band, stick on like a patch, attach to your shirt like a cufflink, or show off in the form of fashion jewellery! Coming in exciting, highly fashionable and artistic forms, these help improve health, fitness, posture, beauty, personal safety, coaching, social interactions and more.

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There has been a dramatic improvement in the availability, variety and performance of wearable devices, thanks to technological advancements in areas like batteries, materials, processors and sensors. Let's take a look at some of the hottest devices in this space